NGL Schools Gymnastics: a pitch for schools

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Why gymnastics: the sport that powers every sport

Every sport starts here. Gymnastics teaches children to jump, land, roll, balance, turn, hold their body weight and control their movement. Football, rugby, netball, swimming and dance are all built on those movements. A child who does gymnastics is better prepared for every other sport they try.

It is also the one activity named in the PE national curriculum for building these skills. At Key Stage 1 pupils must develop balance, agility and coordination. At Key Stage 2 they must develop flexibility, strength, technique, control and balance, "for example, through athletics and gymnastics" (national curriculum).

> **"Gymnastics is the foundation of all sports."** Morinari Watanabe, President of World Gymnastics, President's report to the 2026 World Gymnastics Congress

The sport's world governing body is putting schools at the centre. In his 2026 Congress report, President Watanabe set out the work of World Gymnastics' School Curriculum Working Group, which is building materials so that primary school teachers around the world can "teach gymnastics more easily". NGL Schools does exactly that in British schools today: a ready-made programme, routines on video and a local club behind every teacher.

What children develop	How NGL Schools builds it
Strength	Front, back and side supports, press-ups, burpees, holding the body in a handstand
Balance	Single-leg and arabesque balances, walking and turning on a bench
Flexibility	Straddle, pike, bridge and splits
Coordination and agility	Jumps, turns, rolls, cartwheels and vaults off a springboard
Body control and safe landing	Taught landing position at every level, so children learn to fall and land safely
Confidence	Six levels, each one achievable, with a certificate and medal to mark it

What children develop	How NGL Schools builds it
Listening and discipline	Children follow set routines and coach instructions, and wait their turn safely
Performance	Each level ends with a routine performed in front of others, building up to a Graduation
Resilience	Children practise a skill until it works, then move on to the next one

It suits every child. Boys and girls take part together, at their own level. No child sits on a bench waiting to be picked. It needs no pitch or good weather, so it runs indoors all year round.

Children need it. Only 49% of children in England get the hour a day of activity the Chief Medical Officers recommend, and 28% manage less than 30 minutes (Sport England, Active Lives 2024–25).

Why NGL Schools: a pathway, not a one-off

Most school sport offers stop when the term ends. NGL Schools is the school stage of one connected pathway, run by the National Gymnastics League (NGL), that a child can follow from pre-school to university and beyond:

1. **Pre-School:** first movement skills, in the club
2. **Schools:** the NGL Schools Awards Scheme, in your school
3. **Recreational:** weekly club classes, 1–2 hours a week
4. **General League:** competing for the club, 2–10 hours a week
5. **Performance League:** 11+ hours a week
6. **University League:** gymnastics at university
7. **Masters:** gymnastics for adults



Backed by your local British Gymnastics club. NGL Schools is delivered with a local British Gymnastics (BG) registered club. Your pupils can go on to train in real gymnastics facilities, with sprung floors, vaults, bars and trampolines.

Children can carry on after school. A child who enjoys the programme has a club ready to take them on. They can join weekly classes and compete in NGL leagues against other clubs.

School sport funding is changing, and NGL Schools fits the new model

The PE and Sport Premium, worth £320m a year, ends after this school year. Primary schools have used it for a decade to buy in sports coaching. The government announced the change on 21 May 2026 (Tes).

When	What happens
Autumn 2026	A final, reduced payment: £6,240 plus £10 per pupil, around 40% of a normal year (DfE conditions of grant)
September 2026	Ofsted starts looking at each school's enrichment offer against the DfE enrichment framework (The Key)
January 2027	A new PE and School Sport Partnerships Network starts up, run by one national delivery partner
April 2027	Network support begins. There are no more direct payments to schools: most schools get training, guidance and resources, with extra coaching aimed at schools in greatest need (Landscape & Amenity)
31 July 2027	Deadline to spend this year's payment and publish the school's PE report

This year's money cannot pay for coaches who cover teachers' planning (PPA) time or teach the existing PE curriculum. It must make "additional and sustainable improvements" to PE and sport.

What this means for your school:

- **Bought-in coaching will be hard to fund from April 2027.** NGL Schools has an option that costs the school nothing.
- **Training your own staff is what the funding supports.** Our teacher-led option trains your teachers to run gymnastics themselves. The skills stay in your school after the money has gone.
- **Ofsted now looks at enrichment.** An after-school gymnastics club with awards, routines and a Graduation gives you a clear, evidenced enrichment offer.
- **The new Network is built on links between schools, clubs and governing bodies.** NGL Schools already links your school to a local British Gymnastics club.

- **You need to show impact.** Each child's Awards Book records the skills they have passed. Certificates and medals mark each level, so you can show progress, not just attendance.

Two ways to run NGL Schools

Your school chooses how it runs the programme. In both options, the children get the same awards, routines and Graduation.

	Option 1: Teacher-led	Option 2: After-school club
Who delivers it	Your teachers, in PE lessons, trained and supported by the club	Club coaches, after school on your site
When	In the school day	After school, which also gives parents extra childcare
Cost to the school	A small yearly fee per school, paid to the club (from £750, set by your club), plus Awards Books bought from the club	Nothing. Parents pay the club directly
Cost to families	Optional: Graduation	Weekly club fee, Awards Book and Graduation
Club support	Training, a monthly visit and a dedicated club contact	Coaches run every session
What stays in school	Teachers who can teach gymnastics with confidence	An enrichment club for Ofsted, with no staff time needed
Best for	Schools that want to build their own PE skills	Schools with no budget, or that want more after-school provision

Option 1: Teacher-led (train the trainer). The club trains your teachers to deliver the six levels in PE lessons. Teachers get the full support pack below. A club coach visits once a month to help teach, check progress and assess children for their awards. Because it trains your own staff, it makes the "additional and sustainable" improvement the PE funding asks for.

Option 2: After-school club (free to the school). The club runs a weekly gymnastics club in your hall after school. Parents book and pay the club directly, so there is no cost or admin for the school. Working parents get an extra hour of childcare, and your school gets an enrichment club with clear results.

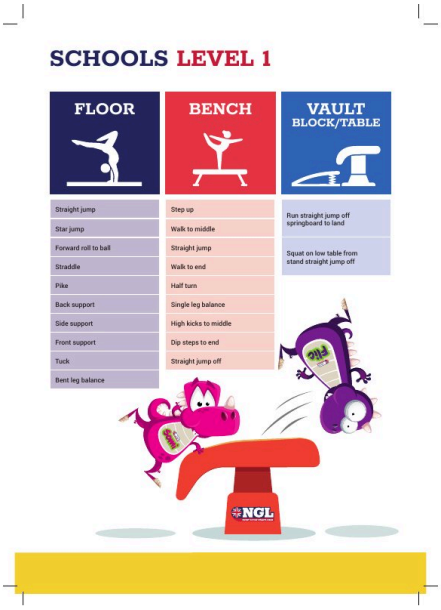
Everything your teachers need

Teachers don't need to be gymnastics experts. Every skill is set out step by step, every routine is on video, and the club is there to help.

What you get	What it does
NGL Schools Awards Book	One book per child, covering six levels (Shapes, Control, Strength, Develop, Perform, Master). Each child keeps it as a record of the skills they have passed.
Certificates	Bronze in term 1, Silver in term 2 and Gold in term 3, so every child is rewarded as they progress
Medals	An NGL Schools medal for each level completed, presented at Graduation
Teacher Support Pack	A course overview of all six levels, plus a coach's guide for each level with a picture of every skill, from a straight jump to a handstand
Routine videos	Each level's floor, block and bench routines on video. Families can watch them at home in the NGL Schools Hub with the club's code.
Dedicated club support	A named contact at your local British Gymnastics club
Monthly club visits	A club coach visits once a month to support lessons and assess awards (Option 1)
Graduation at your local club	Children perform their routines at the club in front of their families, and receive their medal

The Awards Book. Each child gets their own book. It lists the floor, bench and vault skills for every level, and has a progress tracker for their certificates.







Certificates and medals. Children earn a Bronze certificate in term 1, Silver in term 2 and Gold in term 3. With all three, they have completed the level and can perform at a Graduation to receive their NGL Schools medal.



The Teacher Support Pack. The course overview shows every skill in the floor, block and bench routines for all six levels. The coach's guide for each level then shows each skill in pictures.

NGL SCHOOLS AWARDS SCHEME — COURSE OVERVIEW

★ BUILDING CONFIDENCE, ONE SKILL AT A TIME ★

LEVELS 1–6

FLOOR ROUTINE

LEVEL 1	LEVEL 2	LEVEL 3	LEVEL 4	LEVEL 5	LEVEL 6
• Straight jump • Star jump • Forward roll to ball • Straddle • Pike • Back support • Side support • Front support • Tuck • Bent leg balance	• Straight jump • Star jump • Tuck jump • Forward roll to ball • Straddle • Pike • Back support • Side support • Front support • Tuck • Sideways bunny jump x 3 • Straight leg balance	• Tuck jump • 1/2 jump x 2 • Forward roll to ball • Shoulder stand • Bridge • Straddle • Pike • Back support • Side support • Front support • Press up x 3 • Burpee • Arabesque • Cartwheel	• 1/1 jump • Forward roll to stand • Tuck • Shoulder stand no hands • Japana 45 degrees • Bridge • Back support • Leg lift each leg • Side support • Front support • Press up x 3 • Burpee • Arabesque • Cartwheel • L' handstand	• Straight jump • 1/1 jump • Forward roll to straddle stand • Straight • Tuck • Headstand tucked • Tuck • Bridge • Back support • Front support • Press up x 5 • Burpee • Arabesque leg horizontal • Cartwheel • Handstand • One free move	• Straight jump • 1/1 jump • Forward roll to straddle stand • Straight • Tuck • Headstand straight • Tuck • Bridge leg raise • Back support • Front support • Press up x 5 • Burpee • Arabesque leg horizontal • One handed Cartwheel • Handstand • One free move • One free move

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BLOCK ROUTINE

LEVEL 1	LEVEL 2	LEVEL 3	LEVEL 4	LEVEL 5	LEVEL 6
• Run straight jump off springboard to land • Squat on low table from stand straight jump off	• Run star jump off springboard to land • Squat on low table from stand star jump off	• Run tuck jump off springboard to land • Run squat on tuck jump off	• Run straddle jump off springboard to land • Run squat on star jump off	• Run star jump off springboard over low table • Run side vault over, tucked legs	• Run tuck jump off springboard over low table • Run side vault over, straight legs

BENCH ROUTINE

LEVEL 1	LEVEL 2	LEVEL 3	LEVEL 4	LEVEL 5	LEVEL 6
• Step up • Walk to middle • Straight jump • Walk to end • Half turn • Single leg balance • High kicks to middle • Dip steps to end • Straight jump off	• Step up • Walk on toes to middle • Straight jump • Tuck jump • Walk in toes to end • Half spin on toes • Single leg balance • Bunny jumps to middle • Rebound jumps to end • Star jump off	From end • Travelling Bunny jumps side to side into middle • Bunny jump on • Straight jump • Star jump • Tuck jump • Tuck shape • Shoulder stand • Roll to stand • Dip steps to end • Walk backwards to middle • Half turn on toes • High knee single leg balance • Cat leaps to end • Half turn jump off	• Squat on in the middle • Straddle stand or Side splits • Tuck shape • Quarter turn in tuck • Tuck walk to end • Half spin on toes • Forward roll to stand (mat can be slid in) • Dip steps to end • Half spin • Arabesque • Cat leaps to middle • Cartwheel off the end	• Jump to wide straddle or side splits • push to stand • Star jump • Tuck jump • Half turn jump • Side chasse to end • Cartwheel (mat can be slid in) • Forward roll (mat) • Arabesque • Kick turn • Step or skip step into round off then end	• Jump into forward roll (mat) • Straddle lever • Swing legs behind push to stand • Split leap to end • Half spin • Half handstand • Cartwheel (mat) • Tuck headstand (mat) • Arabesque to horizontal • Skip step round off of the end

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ABOUT THE LEVELS

SHAPES	CONTROL	STRENGTH	DEVELOP	PERFORM	MASTER
Build basic shapes, movement skills and confidence.	Develop control, independence and core movement.	Build strength, flexibility and coordination.	Develop precision, hold and control.	Perform dynamic and complex skills with control.	Master advanced skills and confident presentation.

SUCCESS COMES FROM:
- ✓ Consistent practice
- ✓ Listening to your coach
- ✓ Positive attitude
- ✓ Trying your best

REMEMBER!
- ✓ Safety first, always
- ✓ Encourage every gymnast
- ✓ Celebrate every success
- ✓ Respect your teammates

KEY TO IMPROVEMENT
- ★ LEARN new skills
- ★ PRACTICE with focus
- ★ PERFORM with confidence
- ★ CELEBRATE every achievement

★ EVERY SPORT STARTS HERE ★ EVERY SPORT STARTS HERE ★ EVERY SPORT STARTS HERE ★ EVERY SPORT STARTS HERE

NGL
SCHOOLS AWARDS SCHEME

COACH'S GUIDE

★ BUILDING CONFIDENCE, ONE SKILL AT A TIME ★

LEVEL 1

STRAIGHT JUMP



STAR JUMP



FORWARD ROLL TO BALL



STRADDLE



PIKE



BACK SUPPORT



SIDE SUPPORT



FRONT SUPPORT



TUCK



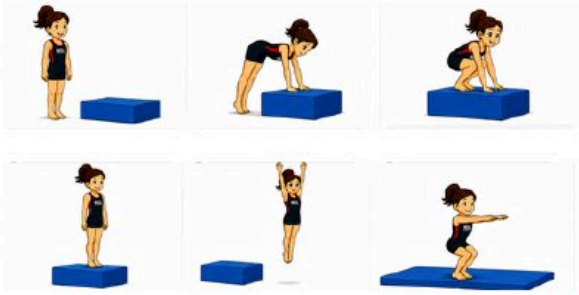
BENT LEG BALANCE



RUN STRAIGHT JUMP OFF SPRINGBOARD TO LAND



SQUAT ON LOW TABLE FROM STAND STRAIGHT JUMP OFF



STEP UP



WALK TO MIDDLE



STRAIGHT JUMP



WALK TO END



HALF TURN



SINGLE LEG BALANCE



HIGH KICKS TO MIDDLE



DIP STEPS TO END



STRAIGHT JUMP OFF



LANDING POSITION



★ EVERY SPORT STARTS HERE ★ EVERY SPORT STARTS HERE ★ EVERY SPORT STARTS HERE ★ EVERY SPORT STARTS HERE

The Graduation. When children complete a level, they perform their routines in front of their families, at your local club or at your school. Families pay £10 per child, which includes the medal. For many children it's their first time performing. At the club, it's also their first visit to a real gymnastics hall.

NGL Schools t-shirt. Children can also have their own NGL Schools t-shirt, sold through the club (suggested price £17 to £20).



Costs at a glance

	Option 1: Teacher-led	Option 2: After-school club
School pays	Yearly fee from £750, plus Awards Books from the club	£0
Families pay	Graduation, £10 (optional)	The club's weekly fee, an Awards Book (£10) and Graduation (£10)
Staff time	Teachers deliver it in PE lessons	None

Exact prices are set by your local club.

Getting started

1. Choose Option 1, Option 2, or both.

2. Meet your local club to agree dates, year groups and the hall.
3. The club brings Awards Books, certificates and the Teacher Support Pack.
4. Children work through the levels during the year.
5. Children perform at their Graduation at the club.

Sources

- Tes: PE and sport premium for primary schools scrapped
- GOV.UK: Primary PE and sport premium conditions of grant, 2026 to 2027
- Landscape & Amenity: Government delivers PE and school sport funding update (July 2026)
- School Business Services: The end of the PE Premium
- All In Compass: What schools and activity providers need to know
- The Key: DfE enrichment framework and benchmarks
- Sport England: Active Lives Children and Young People 2024–25
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- World Gymnastics: Bulletin 272, President's report (August 2026)